

# Jan Pfänder

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## Positions

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| <b>Swiss Federal Institute of Aquatic Science and Technology (Eawag)</b><br>Postdoctoral researcher<br>• Advisor: Viktoria Cologna | Zurich, Switzerland<br>Sep 2025 - present |
| <b>Cambridge University</b><br>Visiting Researcher<br>• Host: Sander van der Linden                                                | Cambridge, UK<br>Mai 2026 - Jun 2026      |

## Education

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| <b>PhD</b> <b>École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL), Institut Jean Nicod, Psychology</b><br>• Supervisors: Hugo Mercier & Kevin Arceneaux<br>• Thesis: Essays on Understanding Trust in Science                | Paris, France<br>2022 - 2025     |
| <b>MA</b> <b>École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL), Cognitive Science</b><br>• Supervisor: Hugo Mercier<br>• Thesis: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other? | Paris, France<br>2020 - 2022     |
| <b>MA</b> <b>Universität Freiburg, Journalism (1st year)</b>                                                                                                                                                | Freiburg, Germany<br>2019 - 2020 |
| <b>BA</b> <b>Universität Konstanz, Political Science and Public Administration</b>                                                                                                                          | Konstanz, Germany<br>2014 - 2018 |

## Work Experience

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| <b>Direction Interministérielle de la Transformation Publique (DITP)</b><br>Research Intern | Paris, France<br>Jun 2021 - Aug 2021           |
| <b>Assemblée Nationale</b><br>Parliamentary Assistant                                       | Paris, France<br>Sep 2018 - Jul 2019           |
| <b>University of St. Gallen</b><br>Research Assistant                                       | St. Gallen, Switzerland<br>Jun 2017 - Jul 2018 |

## Publications

Peer-reviewed publications  
(*n* = 5)

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| <b>Global studies on trust in science suggest new theoretical and methodological directions</b><br>J. Pfänder, N. G. Mede, V. Cologna<br><a href="https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsyc.2025.102215">https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsyc.2025.102215</a> (Current Opinion in Psychology) | 2026 |
| <b>Trusting but forgetting impressive science</b><br>J. Pfänder, S. de Rouilhan, H. Mercier<br><a href="https://doi.org/10.1163/15685373-12340227">https://doi.org/10.1163/15685373-12340227</a> (Journal of Cognition and Culture)                                              | 2025 |
| <b>Quasi-universal acceptance of basic science in the United States</b><br>J. Pfänder, L. Kerzrehö, H. Mercier<br><a href="https://doi.org/10.1177/09636625251364407">https://doi.org/10.1177/09636625251364407</a> (Public Understanding of Science)                            | 2025 |
| <b>Spotting false news and doubting true news: a systematic review and meta-analysis of news judgements</b><br>J. Pfänder, S. Altay<br><a href="https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-024-02086-1">https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-024-02086-1</a> (Nature Human Behaviour)              | 2025 |
| <b>How wise is the crowd: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other?</b>                                                                                                                                                          | 2025 |

J. Pfänder, B. de Courson, H. Mercier  
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cognition.2024.106005> (Cognition)

Conference proceedings  
(n = 1)

How wise is the crowd: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other? 2024

J. Pfänder, B. de Courson, H. Mercier  
[escholarship.org/uc/item/4ms2n8wd](https://escholarship.org/uc/item/4ms2n8wd) (Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society)

Large collaborations (minor role)  
(n = 2)

Trust in scientists and their role in society across 68 countries 2025  
V. Cologna, N. G. Mede, S. Berger, ..., J. Pfänder, ... et al.

<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-024-02090-5> (Nature Human Behaviour)

Perceptions of science, science communication, and climate change attitudes in 68 countries - the TISP dataset 2025

N. G. Mede, V. Cologna, S. Berger, ..., J. Pfänder, ... et al.  
<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-024-04100-7> (Scientific Data)

Working papers  
(n = 2)

The rational impression account of trust in science 2025

J. Pfänder, H. Mercier  
[https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/nwka2\\_v1](https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/nwka2_v1)

The French trust more the sciences they perceive as precise and consensual 2025

J. Pfänder, H. Mercier  
[https://doi.org/10.31219/osf.io/k9m6e\\_v1](https://doi.org/10.31219/osf.io/k9m6e_v1)

## Presentations

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### Invited talks

Strengthening Trust in Climate Scientists in the US - A Megastudy Approach 2026

Max Planck Institute for Human Development, Berlin

Trust in science 2025

Paris School of International Affairs (Sciences Po), Paris

### Conference presentations

Trusting but forgetting impressive science 2026

EASP General Meeting, Strasbourg

Strengthening Trust in Climate Scientists in the US - A Megastudy Approach 2026

EASP Small Meeting, Hohenheim

Predicting the effects of a megastudy with behavioral clones 2026

Behavioral Clones Workshop (Max Planck Institute for Human Development), Berlin

Belief in & interventions against misinformation 2025

15th Annual Conference of the European Political Science Association, Madrid

The rational impression account of trust in science 2025

Explaining culture: an interdisciplinary approach, Paris

Spotting False News and Doubting True News. A Meta-Analysis of News Judgments 2025

(Keynote)  
Infox sur Seine, Paris

How wise is the crowd: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other? (Poster) 2024

46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam

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| <b>Processus sous-tendant la confiance dans la science</b><br>5ème édition des Rencontres Jeunes Chercheur·euse·s, Grenoble                     | 2024 |
| <b>Spotting False News and Doubting True News: A Meta-Analysis of News Judgments</b><br>EDMO Scientific Conference on Disinformation, Amsterdam | 2024 |

## Teaching

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### Courses

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| <b>Fact-Checking and Critical Thinking</b><br>Université PSL (Paris Sciences & Lettres) – BA program "Sciences pour un monde durable"<br>• A hands-on introduction to research design for an interdisciplinary BA program<br>• Sole instructor & creator of the course<br>• 30h in-class per semester; one semester a year | 2022 – 2025 |
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### Workshops

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| <b>Meta-analysis for beginners</b><br>Laboratoire de Psychologie du Développement et de l'Éducation de l'Enfant (LaPsyDÉ) | 2024 |
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## Advising

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### Graduate students

- Lou Kerzreho (2023)

### Undergraduate students

- Mateo Pivert (2024)
- Ludivine Million (2024)
- Prune Lefevre Jachimowicz (2024)
- Kevin Chen (2023)
- Théodore Lellouche (2022)

## Professional Service

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### Peer Reviewing

( $n = 10$ )

- Journals: *Nature Climate Change* (1), *Public Understanding of Science* (3), *PNAS Nexus* (1), *Social Science & Medicine* (1), *Društvena istraživanja* (1), *Behavior Research Methods* (1), *Educational Research Review* (1), *Artificial Intelligence Review* (1)

## Summer Schools

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| <b>Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute</b><br>Hosted by the University of St. Andrews, organized by Indiana University Bloomington | St. Andrews, UK<br>2024 |
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## Skills

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**Languages:** German, English, French, Spanish

**Programming:** R, Git (basics), Python (rudimentary)